Fennel and the Big Yellow Excited

A story about feeling excited

by KUZU NOHA

Fennel and the Big Yellow Excited

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For every little bear
with a big feeling.

Tomorrow was the Fair! Hooray, hooray!

Fennel could not wait for the big, big day!

He counted his coins. He brushed his hair.

He was so excited he danced on the stair!

At bedtime, a yellow spark went POP!

It bounced on his pillow, hop, hop, hop!

More sparks came bouncing round and round,

bouncing off the walls with a boing-y sound.

The Big Yellow Excited filled the room.

Fennel bounced on the bed. Zoom, zoom, ZOOM!

His toys went flying. His pillow too.

“I can’t lie down!” he said. “What do I do?”

Papa Bear came and sat on the bed.

“Excited is big,” the kind bear said.

“First, WIGGLE it out! Shake your paws, shake your knees!”

Fennel wiggled and giggled
and shook like the breeze.

“Next, BREATHE. Puff your tummy up big and round,

then let the air out with
a soft, whooshy sound.”

“Last, WAIT. Make a countdown. Cross off the night.

Tomorrow is coming. Tonight, hold on tight.”

The sparks bounced slower,
and slower, then slept.

Fennel cuddled in close,
and a sweet dream crept.

Next day at the Fair, with its lights shining bright,

Fennel wiggled and breathed
and he waited just right.

Fennel's 3 Calm Steps

1. WIGGLE

Shake it out! Wiggle and jump.

2. BREATHE

Puff your tummy up, then let it out.

3. WAIT

Make a countdown. Waiting can be fun.

Excited is okay.

Big days are worth the wait.

A Note for Grown-Ups

Name the feeling: “You feel excited.”

Let your child move first, then breathe together.

Make a simple countdown with stickers or stars.

Praise the waiting, not just the event.

Thank you for reading!

If Fennel helped your little one, a short review on Amazon helps other families find this book.